# 5E LESSON PLAN: WEEK 9 – MISS PATTERSON

- **Institution:** Happy Grove High School
- **Grade Level:** Grade 8
- **Class:** $8^3$
- **Subject:** English Literature
- **Date:** November 9, 2026
- **Duration:** 60 minutes
- **NSC Learning Strand:** Reading for Meaning and Enjoyment (Comprehension & Literature)
- **NSC Attainment Target:** Identify, decode, and interpret sensory imagery and figurative language (similes) within a complete poem; connect these choices to the development of a central theme.
- **Topic:** Poetry Analysis – Close Study of Imagery and Theme in Stephen Spender's "My Parents"
- **Previous Knowledge:** In Week 8, students learned stanza, meter, rhyme scheme, ballad and free verse ("Linstead Market", "The Wreck of the Hesperus" and "Fog"). They have studied characterization and Man vs. Man conflict in Chapters 1–6 of My Father, Sun-Sun Johnson, including Rami being jeered at in Chapter 2.

## Key Vocabulary

**Key Vocabulary (word wall)**

**Speaker:** the voice telling the poem; the speaker is not always the poet

**Sensory imagery:** descriptive language that appeals to the five senses (sight, sound, touch, taste, smell)

**Simile:** a comparison between two different things using "like" or "as" (e.g. "threw words like stones")

**Theme:** the main message or idea about life that a poem or story explores

**Social exclusion:** being left out or kept apart from a group

**Bystander:** a person who sees something happen but is not directly involved

## Learning Objectives

By the end of the lesson:

***Cognitive***

1. After the Explain phase, students will define speaker, sensory imagery, simile and theme, giving one example of each from "My Parents", with at least three of the four correct.
2. Using the Image-to-Theme Organizer, students will analyse how two examples of sensory imagery and one simile from the poem develop the theme of social exclusion, linking all three to the theme.

***Affective***

3. During the group discussion, students will contribute at least one respectful comment that considers the speaker's feelings about being left out.

***Psychomotor***

4. Using the marking key, students will mark at least six descriptive phrases in the poem by sense or simile (underline, circle or box).

## Learning Domains

- **Cognitive:** Define and decode figurative devices; evaluate how sensory imagery builds meaning; connect poetic themes to prose.
- **Affective:** Show empathy for people who are left out; listen respectfully when discussing social or economic differences.
- **Psychomotor:** Mark phrases by sense; complete the organizer; sketch a visual map of a scene.

## Learning Styles

- **Visual:** The marked poem, the Image-to-Theme Organizer and the visual map.
- **Auditory:** Expressive teacher reading, paired analysis and class discussion.
- **Kinaesthetic:** Underlining, circling and boxing sensory phrases; sketching a scene from the poem.

## Resources

- The Engage sentence (in Engage below)
- Printed copies of "My Parents" by Stephen Spender (in Explore below; you supply the poem)
- Students' own pens (no extra materials needed)
- Marking key and pair role slips (in Explore below)
- Image-to-Theme Organizer (in Elaborate below), one per pair
- KWL charts and exit tickets (one per student)
- PowerPoint (projector) and whiteboard

## NSC Major Objectives (Curriculum Alignment)

- Locate and analyse an author's use of figurative language including allusion, idiom, pun and symbolism in a variety of literary text. *(Reading for Meaning and Enjoyment (Comprehension & Literature) – Term 1, Unit 2). Checked by: Exit Ticket Q2 (identify a simile).*
- Use sensory details to categorise and analyse imagery in a range of written texts. *(Reading for Meaning and Enjoyment (Comprehension & Literature) – Term 3, Unit 1). Checked by: Image-to-Theme Organizer (sort imagery by sense and link it to the theme).*

*Sequencing note: the sensory imagery objective is listed for Term 3, Unit 1. This lesson introduces it early through the Term 1 figurative language objective (Term 1, Unit 2), and students will build on it in Term 3.*

## Instructional Strategies

- **KWL Chart:** Engage – what students know and want to know about how poets make us feel.
- **Visual Prompt and Think-Pair-Share:** Engage – pairs analyse the sensory phrase on the board.
- **Teacher Read-Aloud:** Explore – expressive reading of "My Parents".
- **Annotation with Pair Role Slips:** Explore – underline (sight/touch), circle (sound), box (similes).
- **Teacher Modelling:** Explain – the teacher models decoding a simile and linking it to theme.
- **Higher-Order Questioning:** Explain – analyse, compare, evaluate and create questions.
- **Graphic Organizer:** Elaborate – Image-to-Theme Analytical Organizer.
- **Peer Assessment (Star and Wish):** Elaborate – pairs check another pair's organizer.
- **Traffic-Light Self-Assessment and Exit Ticket:** Evaluate – individual check on imagery and theme.

## Subject Integration

- **Science (Explore):** Before marking the poem, students list the five senses and the body part linked to each, and use the list with their marking key.
- **Health and Family Life Education (Elaborate):** Students discuss how the name-calling in the poem is a form of bullying, and suggest one way a bystander could help.

## Classroom Organization and Management

- **Classroom layout and safety:** Desks are arranged in literature pairs facing the board, joined into groups of four for the discussion. Bags hang on the backs of chairs and walkways are kept clear so the teacher can reach every group.
- **Materials:** Cards, strips and worksheets are prepared in labelled envelopes before the lesson, so no time is lost handing them out.
- **Group roles:** For group tasks, each member receives a role slip (see the slips in the procedure) so every student knows exactly what to do and no one is left out.
- **Transitions:** The teacher uses the call-and-response "Class, class!" / "Yes, yes!" as an attention signal, and a visible timer shows how long each phase lasts.
- **Positive reinforcement:** Specific verbal praise, group points on the board, and good work displayed on the word wall.
- **Expectations:** Listen when others speak, respect every answer, share tasks fairly, and handle materials carefully.

## Accommodations (Inclusion)

- **Reading difficulties:** Large-print cards and a reading partner; the teacher reads text aloud on request.
- **Writing difficulties:** Students may answer orally, point to the correct card, or have a peer scribe one answer.
- **Attention or vision needs:** Preferential seating near the board and the teacher.

- **Absent students:** Students who miss the lesson (for example, for sports) receive the notes and classwork as a catch-up pack.
- **Students sensitive to the topic:** The teacher sets ground rules before the discussion (no names, no personal stories unless offered), and any student may pass or write a comment instead of speaking.

### Backup Plan (No Technology)

- **If there is no electricity, internet or projector:** The Engage sentence and definitions are written on the whiteboard; the poem, marking key and organizer are printed.

## 5E PROCEDURE

### 1. ENGAGEMENT (10 minutes)

- **Activating Prior Knowledge:** Students fill in the K and W columns of a KWL chart on "How poets make us feel". The teacher asks: "Last week, what did Sandburg compare the fog to?" (a cat) and "How did Rami feel when the boys laughed at him in Chapter 2?"
- **Student Learning Activity:** Students will analyse an evocative phrase on the board. In pairs, they isolate the specific words that suggest a physical ache or a distinct sound, explain why authors use physical descriptions to show emotional hurt, and record the term "sensory device" in their logs.
- **Teacher Facilitation:** The teacher will display the sentence, record students' answers on the board, and link them to sensory imagery and figurative language. The teacher will ask: "Which words make you feel pain? Which words let you hear something? Did anyone really throw rocks? What is the writer really describing?"

**Engage Sentence**

"The children threw words like heavy rocks, and their sharp laughter stung like a whip across my back."

**KWL Chart: How Poets Make Us Feel (one per student)**

| K – What I Know | W – What I Want to Know | L – What I Learned |
|---|---|---|
| *e.g. Poems can rhyme and have a beat.* | *e.g. How do words make us feel pain?* | *(Completed in Evaluate)* |

- **Technology (in class):** The sentence is shown on a PowerPoint slide and written on the whiteboard; the teacher underlines the pain words and circles the sound words as students call them out.
- **Formative Check:** Each pair names one "pain" word and one "sound" word; the teacher tallies them on the board.

*(Visual & Auditory)*

## 2. EXPLORATION (15 minutes)

- **Student Learning Activity:** Students will listen to an expressive reading of "My Parents". Working in literature pairs, they re-read the poem and mark the lines with their pens: underline physical appearance or touch, circle sound words, and draw a box around comparisons using "like" or "as". Pairs group expressions such as "threw words like stones" and "torn clothes" into sensory categories.
- **Teacher Facilitation:** The teacher will read the poem with deliberate emotional expression, hand out the role slips, and prompt pairs to sort Spender's descriptive language by sense.

**Poem: "My Parents" by Stephen Spender (one copy per student)**

*Paste the poem here or attach your printed copy. The poem is still under copyright, so it is not reproduced in this plan.*

**Word help:** lithe – moving easily and quickly; coarse – rough, rude; lisp – a way of speaking where "s" sounds like "th".

**Marking Key (use your blue or black pen)**

| Mark | What to mark |
|---|---|
| Underline | Physical appearance or touch |
| Circle | Sound words |
| Box | Comparisons using "like" or "as" (similes) |

**Pair Role Slips (swap roles halfway through the poem) (cut out; give one slip to each group member)**

✂️ **Finder**
Read each line aloud and point to the descriptive words.

✂️ **Marker**
Decide with your partner which sense the words appeal to, then underline, circle or box them.

- **Subject Integration (Science):** Before marking the poem, students list the five senses and the body part linked to each, and use the list with their marking key.
- **Formative Check:** The teacher checks that each pair has at least two phrases of each kind marked.
- **Feedback:** The teacher gives specific feedback, e.g. "'Torn clothes' is something we see. Should you underline, circle or box it?"

*(Auditory & Kinaesthetic)*

## 3. EXPLANATION (10 minutes)

- **Student Learning Activity:** Students will copy the definitions into their notebooks and use the teacher's model to decode lines such as "muscles like iron" and "threw mud", explaining how each shows intimidation or childhood vulnerability.
- **Teacher Facilitation:** The teacher will write the definitions on the board and model decoding, showing how the simile "threw words like stones" presents hurtful words as physical injury, supporting the theme of social exclusion.

**Key Definitions (students copy into notebooks)**

**Speaker:** the voice telling the poem. The speaker is not always the poet.

**Sensory imagery:** descriptive language that appeals to the five senses (sight, sound, touch, taste, smell).

**Simile:** a comparison between two different things using "like" or "as" (e.g. "threw words like stones").

**Theme:** the main message or idea about life that a poem or story explores (e.g. social exclusion).

**Teacher's Model**

| Line / phrase | Device / sense | What it shows | Theme link |
|---|---|---|---|
| "threw words like stones" | Simile (touch) | Hurtful words feel like a physical injury | Social exclusion |

**Higher-Order Questions (whole-class discussion)**

1. Analyse: Why does the speaker compare the boys' muscles to iron?
2. Compare: How is the speaker's life different from the lives of the rough boys?
3. Evaluate: Were the parents right to keep their child away from the rough children? Justify your answer.
4. Create: Write your own simile that shows how it feels to be left out.

*Guide answers: iron is hard and strong, so the speaker feels small and afraid; the speaker is protected and well dressed but lonely, while the boys are poor but free; accept a reasoned answer (e.g. they wanted to protect the child, but it kept the child lonely and apart); e.g. "Being left out felt like standing in the rain while everyone else was indoors."*

- **Technology (in class):** The poem is shown on a PowerPoint slide, and the teacher copies the modelled lines onto the whiteboard and marks them using the marking key.
- **Formative Check:** Thumbs up or down: "The speaker of a poem is always the poet." (Thumbs down – false.)

*(Visual & Auditory)*

## 4. ELABORATION (15 minutes)

- **Student Learning Activity:** Students will use their marked details to complete the Image-to-Theme Organizer, analysing how the speaker's envy of the boys' rough freedom builds the poem's meaning. Pairs then join another pair to discuss the bullying in the poem.
- **Teacher Facilitation:** The teacher will hand out the organizers, monitor the pairs, and guide students to connect the theme to concrete sensory words.

**Image-to-Theme Organizer (one per pair)**

| Line / phrase | Sense or simile | What it shows | Theme link |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | |
| | | | |
| | | | |

- **Differentiation Support:** students complete a scaffolded chart with the devices already chosen, using frames such as: "The phrase 'torn clothes' appeals to the sense of _____ and develops a theme of _____."
- **Differentiation Extension:** students write a paragraph connecting the poem's theme of social exclusion to Rami's experience in Chapter 2, when classmates jeer at his bareback horse riding after his father's economic downfall.
- **Subject Integration (Health and Family Life Education):** Groups of four discuss how the name-calling in the poem is a form of bullying, and each group suggests one way a bystander could help.
- **Numeracy Link:** Pairs count how many phrases they marked of each kind and write the similes as a fraction of the total (e.g. 2 out of 8 = ¼).
- **Peer Assessment:** Pairs swap organizers with another pair and check that each theme link makes sense, giving one star and one wish.
- **Feedback:** The teacher reads out one strong theme link and explains why it works.

*(Visual & Kinaesthetic)*

## 5. EVALUATION (10 minutes)

- **Student Learning Activity:** Students will complete the exit ticket on their own, then fill in the L column of their KWL chart and the traffic-light self-assessment.
- **Teacher Facilitation:** The teacher will collect the organizers, make sure students answer the exit ticket on their own, and collect the slips at the end of the 10 minutes.

**Exit Ticket**

1. True or false: the speaker of a poem is always the poet who wrote it.
2. Write one simile from Stephen Spender's poem "My Parents".
3. State one theme the poem explores about childhood and differences between children.

**Teacher Answers: Exit Ticket**

1. False. 2. e.g. "threw words like stones" or "muscles like iron". 3. e.g. social exclusion; the longing to belong; differences between rich and poor children.

- **Self-Assessment:** Students rate each statement with a traffic light.

**Traffic-Light Self-Assessment (students tick one colour for each statement)**

| I can… | Green | Yellow | Red |
|---|---|---|---|
| explain what the speaker of a poem is | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| find a simile and name the sense it appeals to | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| link imagery to the theme of a poem | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |

*Green = I can do this on my own. Yellow = I need a little more practice. Red = I need help.*

- **Closure:** One student completes the sentence aloud: "Poets use sensory imagery to…"
- **Positive Reinforcement:** The teacher praises thoughtful, respectful comments in the discussion and awards class points.

*(Visual & Auditory)*

**Total: 10 + 15 + 10 + 15 + 10 = 60 minutes**

## Homework / Extension Assignment (Graded – 10 marks): Comparing Rami and the Speaker

In a 5-sentence paragraph, identify one major similarity and one major difference between the peer exclusion experienced by Rami in My Father, Sun-Sun Johnson and by the speaker in the poem "My Parents". Support your paragraph with one quotation from each text.

***Grading Criteria (10 marks)***

| Criteria | What is expected | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| **Similarity** | One clear similarity between Rami and the speaker | 2 |
| **Difference** | One clear difference between their experiences | 2 |
| **Quotation from the novel** | A relevant quotation from My Father, Sun-Sun Johnson | 2 |
| **Quotation from the poem** | A relevant quotation from "My Parents" | 2 |
| **Writing** | Five complete sentences in Standard Jamaican English, with correct capital letters and full stops | 2 |
| **Total** | | **10** |

***Technology Integration (Homework & Practice)***

- **Google Classroom:** Post the poem and the homework instructions. Students submit their comparison paragraph on Google Classroom.
- **Quizizz:** Assign an optional practice quiz on speaker, sensory imagery, similes and theme.

## Assessment Summary

| Type | What is assessed |
|---|---|
| **Diagnostic** | KWL chart (K and W) and responses to the Engage sentence. |
| **Formative** | Marked poem; Image-to-Theme Organizer with peer feedback; thumbs check. |
| **Summative** | Exit ticket; comparison paragraph homework (10 marks). |

## Success Criteria

Students are successful when they can identify one simile from the poem, name the sense it appeals to, and state a theme the poem explores about childhood exclusion.

## Link to Previous and Next Lesson

- **Previous:** Week 8 – Introduction to poetry: ballads and free verse.
- **Next:** Week 10 – Plot structure of the whole novel on Freytag's Pyramid.

## APA References


- Ministry of Education, Youth and Information. (2018). *National Standards Curriculum: Language and Literature Grades 7–9*. Kingston, Jamaica: MoEYI.
- Ministry of Education, Skills, Youth and Information. (n.d.). *Curriculum analysis: Essential objectives & content focus – NSC Grades 7–9* (2nd ed.). Kingston, Jamaica.
- Palmer, C. E. (1974). *My father, Sun-Sun Johnson*. Macmillan Caribbean.
- Spender, S. (1985). *Collected poems 1928–1985*. Faber & Faber.

**Lesson Evaluation (complete after teaching)**

**What went well:**

_____

_____

**What to improve:**

_____

_____

**Students who need follow-up:**

_____